Crypto Price Odds · BTC

Market data as of 2026-10-18 17:19 UTC
Oct 18, 2026, 1:19 PM New York · refreshed daily

CRYPTO FORECASTING RESEARCH · BTC · ETH · XRP · LINK

Will Bitcoin, Ether, XRP and Chainlink move up, down or sideways over the next 30 days? Below: what our tested models expect for each coin, which model has the best record, and what live Deribit option prices imply for each listed expiry. The research behind it asks whether price history or machine learning can beat a simple base rate.

30-day outlook: what the models expect

For each coin: the call (UP, DOWN or FLAT), the chances of a move of more than 10% over the next 30 days, and the model with the best record on the final test. Recomputed daily from fresh prices; as of Oct 18, 2026.

Direction: not predictable · no reliable edge found

Machine-learning models built to read trend and momentum were reliably **worse** than the base rate in 10 of 22 tests and reliably better in 0. For 3 of 4 coins, long-run history and the past year's trend point in opposite directions. So any UP or DOWN call below is a lean, not a forecast with a proven edge.

Size of moves: partly predictable · the models' real edge

Volatility models, which forecast how far prices swing rather than which way, had positive skill against the base rate in 17 of 22 development tests (up to +14.2%). On the one-time final test, none passed every condition: the best, for BTC, was within noise. The ranges below are the most useful part of each outlook.

BTC

$81,378 · close of Oct 17, 2026

▶ FLAT

No directional edge. Most likely stays within ±10% ($73,240–$89,516): 64% chance.

▼ down >10% **18%** within ±10% **64%** ▲ up >10% **18%**

80% range in 30 days **$70,326 – $93,051**

Headline model: **Lognormal, 90-day vol**. Best on the final test: +16.2% skill vs the base rate, within noise (95%: −7.9% to +44.3%). It forecasts the size of moves, not their direction.

Direction signals

Long-run history ▲ up +14 pts Past-year trend ▼ down −8 pts

Options market (Nov 27, 2026, 40d) **▼ 17% · ▲ 21%**

How the call is made. Headline model: the best skill on the sealed final test (spot prices, 30 days) for that asset, or the base rate if no model beat it. UP or DOWN only when the headline model estimates direction and its chances of a move up or down of more than 10% differ by 5 points or more; otherwise FLAT. Zero-drift volatility models have no view on direction, so they always give FLAT. **Track record:** 16 calls logged since Oct 14, 2026; the first are graded on Nov 13, 2026. These are research outputs, not investment advice.

Reading the options market

Market-implied, not a forecast

Probabilities come from option prices, which include a risk premium (traders pay up for protection). Read them as the market's pricing, not a prediction or advice.

Ranges show quote uncertainty

Options trade with a bid and an ask. The quote range is every probability consistent with those prices: wide when the market is thin, tight when it is liquid.

“Not quoted” is not 0%

Far from today's price no options are quoted, so the market says nothing there. Those targets are marked rather than guessed.

Market snapshot

Every listed expiry at a glance. The median and the 80% range are read off the market-implied curve: 10% of the probability sits below the range and 10% above it.

ASSET	EXPIRY	PRICE TODAY	MARKET MEDIAN	80% MARKET RANGE	CHANCE ABOVE TODAY	IMPLIED VOL
BTC	Nov 27, 2026 · 40 days	$81,077	**$81,577**	$69,749 – $93,883	**52%**	37%
	Dec 25, 2026 · 68 days		**$81,723**	$66,441 – $98,003	**52%**	37%

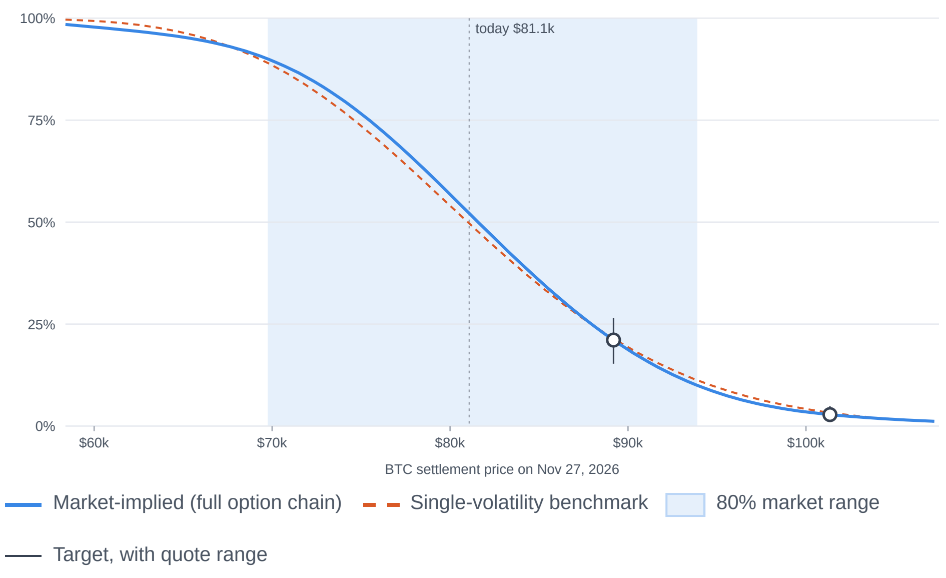
BTC · Nov 27, 2026 (40 days)

Options price a **50% chance BTC settles above $81,577** on Nov 27, 2026, and an **80% chance it lands between $69,749 and $93,883**. The market gives 52% odds it finishes above today's $81,077.

$81,077 BTC price today (settlement index)	**Nov 27, 2026** expiry, 08:00 UTC · 40 days away	**37%** implied volatility (annualised)	**$58k–$120k** prices with quoted options

Chance BTC settles above each price on Nov 27, 2026

inverse options on Deribit · closest listed expiry to 30 days



Upside targets

Chance of settling **above** each price

MOVE VS TODAY	PRICE	MARKET	QUOTE RANGE	BENCHMARK
+10%	$89,185	**21%**	15%–27%	21%
+25%	$101,347	**3%**	1%–5%	3%
+50%	$121,616	not quoted	—	<1% †
+75%	$141,885	not quoted	—	<1% †
+100%	$162,155	not quoted	—	<1% †

Downside targets

Chance of settling **below** each price

MOVE VS TODAY	PRICE	MARKET	QUOTE RANGE	BENCHMARK
−10%	$72,970	**17%**	12%–22%	20%
−25%	$60,808	**3%**	<1%–5%	<1%
−50%	$40,539	not quoted	—	<1% †

Benchmark: the same expiry priced with one volatility for every strike (Black-76). The gap to the market shows how much extra weight traders put on large moves. **Not quoted**: no options trade that far out, so the market gives no reading; † marks a benchmark value extrapolated past the quotes.

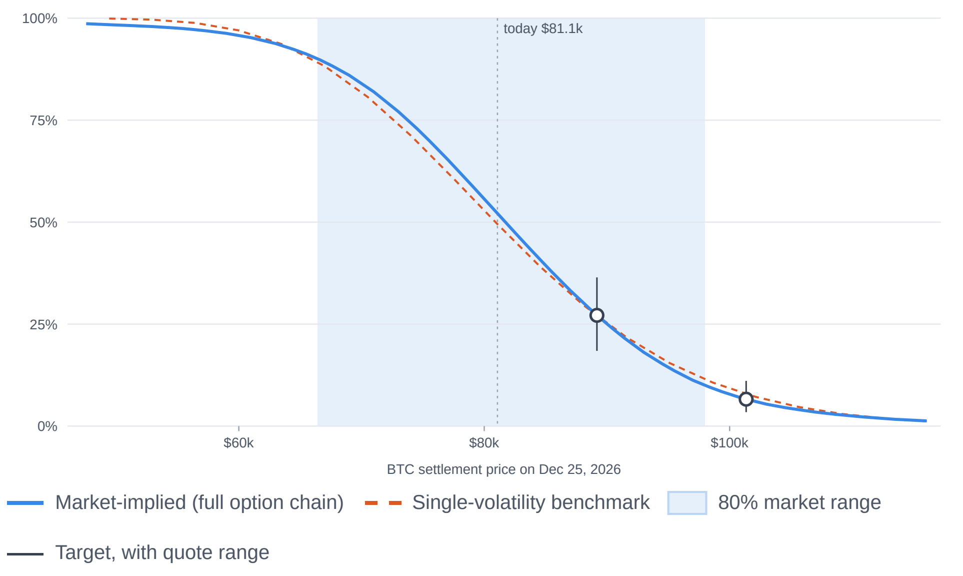
BTC · Dec 25, 2026 (68 days)

Options price a **50% chance BTC settles above $81,723** on Dec 25, 2026, and an **80% chance it lands between $66,441 and $98,003**. The market gives 52% odds it finishes above today's $81,077.

$81,077 BTC price today (settlement index)	**Dec 25, 2026** expiry, 08:00 UTC · 68 days away	**37%** implied volatility (annualised)	**$20k–$230k** prices with quoted options

Chance BTC settles above each price on Dec 25, 2026

inverse options on Deribit · closest listed expiry to 60 and 90 days · year-end expiry



Upside targets

Chance of settling **above** each price

MOVE VS TODAY	PRICE	MARKET	QUOTE RANGE	BENCHMARK
+10%	$89,185	**27%**	18%–36%	27%
+25%	$101,347	**7%**	3%–11%	8%
+50%	$121,616	not quoted	—	<1% †
+75%	$141,885	not quoted	—	<1% †
+100%	$162,155	**<1%**	<1%–<1%	<1%

Downside targets

Chance of settling **below** each price

MOVE VS TODAY	PRICE	MARKET	QUOTE RANGE	BENCHMARK
−10%	$72,970	**23%**	14%–31%	26%
−25%	$60,808	**5%**	3%–8%	4%
−50%	$40,539	**<1%**	<1%–1%	<1%

Benchmark: the same expiry priced with one volatility for every strike (Black-76). The gap to the market shows how much extra weight traders put on large moves. **Not quoted**: no options trade that far out, so the market gives no reading; † marks a benchmark value extrapolated past the quotes.

Can history or machine learning beat the base rate?

Each model forecast the same kind of price targets as the options above, using only data available at the time, and was scored against what actually happened. The yardstick is the **base rate**: how often a move that size happened before.

Mostly no. Across 22 asset × horizon tests, the best price-history model was reliably better than the base rate in only **1**, machine learning in **0**, and the Chronos foundation model in **1** of the 16 it covered. On the sealed final test (the most recent 20% of history, scored once), **no model was promoted**. Only 4 tests had enough outcomes to judge, so this is “no demonstrated improvement”, not proof of no skill.

Settlement prices (Deribit, 08:00 UTC)

ASSET	HORIZON	SEPARATE OUTCOMES	BEST HISTORY MODEL	IMPLIED VOL (DVOL)	BEST MACHINE LEARNING	FOUNDATION MODEL
BTC	30 days	53	Lognormal, 90-day vol **+7.0%**	**+6.4%**	Logistic regression **−10.0%**	Chronos (volatility) **+6.4%**
BTC	60 days	25	GARCH(1,1)-t **+3.6%**	**+4.0%**	Logistic regression **−2.8%**	Chronos (price) **+7.2%**
BTC	90 days	16	GARCH(1,1)-t **+7.8%**	**+4.1%**	Random forest **−5.2%**	—[b]

Spot closes (Coinbase / Bitstamp)

ASSET	HORIZON	SEPARATE OUTCOMES	BEST HISTORY MODEL	IMPLIED VOL (DVOL)	BEST MACHINE LEARNING	FOUNDATION MODEL
BTC	30 days	103	Filtered hist. simulation **−3.0%**	**+2.9%**	Random forest **−12.4%** reliably worse	Chronos (volatility) **−4.9%**
BTC	60 days	50	Filtered hist. simulation **−4.7%**	**+3.2%**	Random forest **−21.5%** reliably worse	Chronos (price) **−5.4%**
BTC	90 days	33	Filtered hist. simulation **−4.5%**	**+4.5%**	Random forest **−27.9%** reliably worse	—[b]

Skill: reduction in forecast error versus the base rate (how often a move that size happened before). 0% = no better, +10% = 10% less error, negative = worse.

Separate outcomes: non-overlapping windows. Daily forecasts overlap, so this count, usually a few dozen, decides how much a result can be trusted.

Reliably better / worse: the 95% interval excludes zero. A result without a tag is within noise.

— [a] the DVOL implied-vol index exists for BTC and ETH only. [b] Chronos forecasts 30 and 60 days only. [c] too little history to train.

Method. Results above are from the development period (Brier skill vs past event frequency (climatology); 95% block-bootstrap interval; development period only). Every forecast used only data available on its date. **Final test:** the last 20% of history (settlement outcomes from 2025-08-30, spot from 2025-04-02) was set aside before any model was built and scored once under a promotion rule fixed in advance. Testable there: spot BTC 30d, spot ETH 30d, spot LINK 30d, spot XRP 30d. ML models (logistic regression, random forest, XGBoost) were trained walk-forward with past-only tuning and shrink-only calibration. None beat the base rate or the best history model in any test. Chronos-Bolt, a pretrained time-series foundation model (Amazon, weights frozen Nov 2024), forecast 30- and 60-day moves from price history alone; it did not beat the best history model in any test, and beat the base rate with confidence in only 1 of 16 (LINK settlement, 60 days, via its volatility forecast), where the best history model also did. Full results, condition by condition, are on the Model Scorecard.

Source: Deribit public API (option chains); probabilities derived, quotes not redistributed. Probabilities are risk-neutral (market-implied) and include any risk premium; they are not forecasts or investment advice. LINK has no listed options on any reachable venue. btabiado.github.io/alpine-data/crypto-odds/ · Engine `81047dd` · odds run `20261018T171954Z_a21a31f9` · findings run `20261014T215853Z_30b31f89`.